

May nothing evil cross this door

Text: Louis Untermeyer, 1923

Music: Robert N. Quaile, b. 1867

OLDBRIDGE 88.84

The musical score is written for a single voice in treble clef, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a 3/4 time signature. The melody consists of quarter and half notes, with some lines ending in a half note followed by a quarter rest. The lyrics are arranged in four systems, each corresponding to a line of music. The first system has four numbered verses. The second system continues the lyrics. The third system has a melisma 'a - bout' over two measures. The fourth system concludes the piece with a double bar line.

1 May noth - ing e - vil cross this door,
2 By faith made strong, the raft - ers will
3 Peace shall walk soft - ly through these rooms,
4 With laugh - ter drown the rau - cous shout,
and may ill for - tune nev - er pry
with - stand the bat - tering of the storm.
touch - ing our lips with ho - ly wine,
and, though these shel - tering walls are thin,
a - bout these win - dows; may the roar
This hearth, though all the world grow chill,
till ev - 'ry cas - ual cor - ner blooms
may they be strong to keep hate out
and rain go by.
will keep you warm.
in - to a shrine.
and hold love in.